



Object Oriented Programming - Glossary

Terms and Definitions

Term	Definition
Properties	Define the characteristics and store the data of an object
Method	A function that makes up the behaviour of an object.
Class	A blueprint - or the plan - of an object
instance	An individual object created from a class
object	Is an instance of a class.
Initialise	To set a newly created object's attributes to their initial state.
Attributes	attributes are the variables defined directly in the class that are shared by all objects of the class
Abstraction	A way of hiding unnecessary details from a user (deals mainly with methods)
Encapsulation	Allows you to have more control over the internal state of your object (deals mainly with properties)

Term	Definition
Inheritance	When a class is created based on an existing class, and the new class inherits the attributes and methods from the existing class
extends	create a new class or child class from an existing or parent class
Getter	A method that gets the value of a property
Setter	A method that sets the value of a property
Polymorphism	One or more methods in the child class that have the same name as methods in the parent class, but do something different
Pascal case	Means that we do not use spaces, and each word starts with a capital letter
Dunder methods	internal, private methods that have leading and trailing double underscores
Init method	a constructor: it allows a class to initialise the attributes of the class

Term	Definition
Self	self: used to represent an instance (object) of the given class
Decorator	A function that allows programmers to modify the behaviour of functions or a class
Docstring	A string that is used to document a section of code
Runtime errors	Are errors that present themselves when we run our code
AttributeError	An error that is raised when an attribute reference or assignment fails
TypeError	Whenever an operation is performed on an incorrect/unsupported object type